Chen (Charlie) FANG

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PERSONAL STATEMENT

Ph.D. Candidate in Applied Economics at Tsinghua University with hands-on experience working inside the UN system and collaborating with multiple international organizations. Previously served as Economist Intern and currently Statistics Assistant at the UNHCR Development Unit, conducting quantitative analysis using large-scale administrative and survey data to inform policies on displacement, refugee return, and market dynamics. Collaborative research with the World Bank and WFP focuses on climate change, poverty alleviation, and inclusive development.

My doctoral research combines applied econometrics, computable general equilibrium (CGE) modeling, and integrated assessment models (IAM) to bridge micro-data evidence with macro-policy simulations. I aspire to work as an economist in international organizations, contributing rigorous analytical tools to global climate governance, development cooperation, and migration/refugee issues.

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

Tsinghua University — Beijing, China

Ph.D. Student, Economics, School of Economics and Management (SEM) — 2023/09 - 2028/07 (Expected)

Research Fields: Environmental Economics, Development Economics, CGE Modeling

Supervisors: Prof. Jing Cao, Co-supervisor: Mun Ho (Harvard)

GPA: 3.9/4.0, Rank 1/63

Harvard University — Cambridge, MA, USA

Visiting Scholar, Harvard China Project — 2026/09 - 2027/08 (Expected)

Peking University — Beijing, China

B.S., Environmental Sciences, College of Environmental Sciences and Engineering (CESE) — 2019 - 2023

B.A., Economics (Double Degree), National School of Development (NSD) — 2021 - 2023

GPA: 3.8/4.0, Rank 1/20

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

UNHCR (United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees), Jordan

Supervisor: Marguerite Duponchel (Senior Development Officer)

Economist Intern, Development Unit — Mar 2025 - Oct 2025

Statistics Assistant, Development Unit — Dec 2025 - Present

- Conduct economic and statistical analysis using R, Stata, and GIS on refugee camp markets, refugee debt burdens, skill-job mismatches, and humanitarian-development linkages.
- Produced policy reports, infographics, and interactive dashboards (e.g., WFP-UNHCR Skills/Work Experience of Syrian Returnees) used by Jordanian ministries and other INGO agencies.
- Collaborated with WFP and World Bank teams on displacement and economic inclusion.
- Co-authored the working paper "Who Goes Home? Economic Constraints and Refugee Return from Jordan", using administrative and survey microdata to analyze drivers of return decisions.

- Use the VAF dataset to analyze the distribution of mental health severity and develop statistical models to identify its potential drivers.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

Energy Foundation China Project (Tsinghua University, DRC of the State Council)

Team Member, "China Industry Relocation and Regional Development under the Double Carbon Targets"

Supervisors: Prof. Jing Cao, Mun Ho — Jan 2023 - Present

- Simulate industrial relocation and policy scenarios, such as carbon taxation, differentiated tax-subsidy schemes, and population mobility policies, using a provincial CGE model.
- Conduct visualization and quantitative analysis of model outputs, including sectoral relocation patterns, GDP/emission impacts, and welfare effects.
- Drafted the final project report and developed accompanying presentation materials.

Tsinghua University - Institute of Energy, Environment, and Economy (3E)

PI: Da Zhang — Aug. 2021 - Present

Research Assistant, "Economic Impact of Carbon Peak and Neutrality"

- Extract and analyze large-scale environmental and economic datasets; update health-impact modules in a CGE model using pollution exposure data.
- Model economic losses from slow-onset climate change events across China.
- Co-authored working paper "An Integrated Assessment of Provincial Economic Damages from Climate Change in China" (under review).

Peking University - Institute of New Structural Economics

Supervisor: Jiajun Xu — Jul. 2022 - Sep. 2022

Research Assistant for UN CDP Background Paper No. 35

- Updated data and figures for Nepal's growth analysis using the GIFF framework.
- Revised the report to incorporate COVID-19 impacts and Nepal's graduation from LDC status.
- Final report published by UN ESCAP in 2024.

Institute of Finance and Sustainability (IFS)

Supervisor: Jiayin Zhao — Jun. 2022 - Oct. 2022

Intern, ESG "Collaborative Engagement" Program

- Reviewed institutional investor decarbonization activities and contributed to the report "Accelerating Climate Action: Collaborative Engagement for Corporate Low-Carbon Transition."

Peking University - National School of Development

PI: Cong Peng — Jan. 2023 - Aug. 2023

Research Assistant, Verified Carbon Standard (VCS) Project

- Reconstructed encrypted forest coordinate data; corrected spatial datasets using GIS.

Undergraduate Research Project: Global Bioenergy Supply and SDG Trade-offs

PI: Hancheng Dai — Sep. 2021 - Jun. 2023

- Built scenarios using the GLOBIOM integrated assessment model, quantifying interactions between bioenergy, food security, land use, and climate mitigation.
- Published related work in *Applied Energy*.

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Tsinghua University, School of Economics and Management

- Environmental & Resource Economics (Undergraduate/International Class, English) 2025 Fall
- Topics in Microeconomics (PhD Course, English) 2025 Summer
- Intermediate Microeconomics (Undergraduate, English) 2024 Fall
- Managerial Economics (MBA Course) 2024 Fall
- Principles of Economics I & II (Undergraduate) 2023 Fall / 2024 Spring

Peking University, National School of Development

- Intermediate Microeconomics (Economics Double-Degree Program) 2023 Spring

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

- 7th WCERE (World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists) (Carcavelos, Portugal) 2026
- 4th JDC Research Conference on Forced Displacement (Bangkok, Thailand) 2026
- 12^{th} International Conference on Information Technology and Quantitative Management (Online) 2025
- 2025 Peking-Tsinghua-Waseda Forum on Macroeconomics for Ph.D. Students (Online) 2025
- 3^{rd} Annual Conference of Chinese Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (Hangzhou) 2024

SOCIAL & POLICY ENGAGEMENT

- Insight China – Xiamen Field Research Program, Tsinghua University Nov 2025
- Rural Revitalization Workstation Program, Xiangxiang (Hunan) Jan 2025
- Sino-German Climate Study Camp (GAUC Climate × Summer School) Sep 2024
- Tsinghua–CASS Rural Revitalization Field Study (Guizhou & Hunan) Jan 2024
- TECC Education Program, Dengfeng, Henan Jul 2023
- PKU International Organization Talent Office (PKUIO) 2021 - 2023
- MUN Climate Change Conference (MCCCOP 6) – Drafted position paper & statements Sep 2021

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed Papers

- Peng, H., Fang, C., ... & Zhang, X. (2026). An Integrated Assessment of Provincial Economic Damages from Climate Change in China. *Journal of Environmental Management*, 415, 130689.
- Cao, J., Fang, C., Wang, B., Hu, X., & Yan, S. (2025). Assessment of the Impact of the EU's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism on China in the Context of Global Climate Governance. *Procedia Computer Science*, 266, 16-23.
- Wu, Y., Deppermann, A., Havlík, P., Frank, S., Ren, M., Zhao, H., ... & Dai, H. (2023). Global land-use and sustainability implications of enhanced bioenergy import of China. *Applied Energy*, 336, 120769.
- Ren, M., Ma, T., Fang, C., Liu, X., Guo, C., Zhang, S., ... & Huang, C. (2023). Negative emission technology is key to decarbonizing China's cement industry. *Applied Energy*, 329, 120254.
- Ren, M., Huang, C., Wu, Y., Deppermann, A., Frank, S., Havlík, P., ... & Dai, H. (2023). Enhanced food system efficiency is the key to China's 2060 carbon neutrality target. *Nature Food*, 1-13.

Reports

- Chapter 3 "AI and the Climate Crisis", UNDP flagship report: *The Next Great Divergence: Why AI May Widen Inequality Between Countries* (2025), joint with Xian Hu (EDF), Jian Zhang (THU)

Selected Working Papers

- Who Goes Home? Economic Constraints and Refugee Return from Jordan, joint with Marguerite Duponchel (UNHCR), Erwin Knippenberg (World Bank) and Daniel Kryger (World Bank)
- Down the Drain? The Impact of Wastewater Treatment Plants on Residential Property Values, joint with Tingwei Gao (PKU) and Yana Jin (PKU)

AWARDS

Tsinghua University

- First-class Comprehensive Scholarship (2025 Fall)

Peking University

- Environmental Alumni Scholarship (2022 Fall), Academic Excellence Scholarships (2020 & 2022), Merit Student Award (2021 Fall)

SKILLS

Language	Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)
Programming	LaTeX, Python, R, STATA, QGIS

Last Updated: October 13, 2026